



● Business Problems Faced by Amazon India (Fashion Segment)

Problem 1 — High Cancellation Rate Bleeding Revenue

Amazon India was losing **13.32% of all orders** to cancellations — that's **17,185 orders** out of 128,975 simply disappearing before delivery. In fashion, cancellations are especially damaging because inventory gets locked, logistics costs are still partially incurred, and the slot cannot be reassigned in real time.

The problem was worse at the category level. **Saree (14.69%), Kurta (14.66%), and Set (14.60%)** — the three highest-revenue categories — also had the highest cancellation rates. The company was essentially losing its biggest bets most frequently.

How this project solved it: SQL query 10 and 15 quantified the overall and per-category cancellation rates precisely. The analysis exposed that the problem isn't uniform — it's concentrated in specific categories, pointing directly at root causes like poor size guides, inaccurate product images, or COD-driven impulse orders with no commitment. The recommendation to introduce size standardisation, better listing quality, and Try-Before-You-Buy for high-value Sets gives the business a targeted fix rather than a blanket policy.

Problem 2 — Revenue Was Declining Month Over Month With No Visibility

The business had no clear picture of whether April's strong numbers were a trend or a peak. In reality, **revenue fell 18.8% in just two months** — from ₹2.70 Crore in April to ₹2.19 Crore in June — but without structured monthly analysis, this decline would appear buried in aggregate totals.

This is a classic "looking at the wrong number" problem. Total revenue of ₹7.34 Crore sounds healthy until you see that the trend line is sharply downward.

How this project solved it: Query 12 (monthly revenue) and Query 17 (top category per month) together revealed the decline trajectory and confirmed that even the best-performing category — Set — was losing revenue each month. The Power BI dashboard made this trend immediately visible to non-technical stakeholders with a month-over-month line chart, enabling leadership to ask the right follow-up questions about marketing spend and seasonal demand.

Problem 3 — No Geographic Strategy — Money Left on the Table

Amazon India had no structured way of knowing which states deserved more marketing investment versus which were low-return. Resources were likely spread too thin across all geographies equally, despite massive revenue concentration in just a handful of states.

Maharashtra alone generated ₹1.24 Crore — nearly the same as the next two states (Karnataka + UP) combined. Meanwhile, dozens of low-revenue states were consuming equivalent logistics and marketing attention.

How this project solved it: Query 8 identified the Top 10 states by revenue, and Query 16 used a **NTILE(3) window function** to algorithmically classify every state into Top Tier, Mid Tier, and Low Tier based on revenue. This gives the marketing and logistics team a data-backed segmentation framework — invest heavily in Top Tier, nurture Mid Tier with targeted campaigns, and minimise burn in Low Tier markets. This is strategic resource allocation, not guesswork.

Problem 4 — Merchant Fulfilment Was Underperforming But Nobody Knew Why

Amazon operates two fulfilment models — Amazon-fulfilled (FBA) and Merchant-fulfilled. The business suspected FBA performed better but had no quantified comparison to act on.

The analysis revealed a stark gap: **Amazon-fulfilled orders (65.1% of volume) generated 69.3% of revenue**, meaning the average order value was noticeably higher through FBA. Merchant-fulfilled orders were dragging down the per-order revenue average and likely contributing disproportionately to returns and cancellations due to less standardised handling.

How this project solved it: Query 14 directly compared both fulfilment models across order count, total revenue, and average order value. The business can now use this data to build a case for migrating high-value merchant sellers onto FBA, or introducing fulfilment quality incentives tied to seller ratings.

Problem 5 — Category Strategy Was Based on Assumption, Not Data

Before this analysis, business decisions about which categories to promote, stock more deeply, or discount were likely driven by intuition or last year's performance. There was no monthly view of which category actually led revenue in any given period.

The assumption might have been that Kurta — the highest order count category — was the top revenue generator. In fact, **Set consistently outperformed every other category in all three months**, despite having fewer orders, because its per-order value was significantly higher.

How this project solved it: Query 9 (category revenue and units sold) and Query 17 (top category per month using RANK + PARTITION BY) together corrected this assumption. Set should receive priority shelf placement, premium ad spend, and exclusive launch slots. Kurta, despite high volume, needs a different strategy focused on reducing returns rather than driving more orders.

Problem 6 — B2B Segment Was Invisible and Ignored

With **only 794 B2B orders out of 128,975 total (0.62%)**, Amazon India's fashion business was essentially operating as a pure B2C platform. But B2B buyers — boutiques, resellers, corporate gifting, uniform suppliers — tend to place large, recurring, high-value orders with low return rates.

The company had no visibility into whether B2B was growing, shrinking, or concentrated in specific categories or states. Without measurement, the segment cannot be managed or grown.

How this project solved it: Query 6 isolated and quantified B2B vs B2C order split for the first time in this analysis cycle. The finding creates a business case for a dedicated B2B programme — bulk pricing tiers, account managers for repeat business buyers, and a separate B2B portal — which could meaningfully diversify revenue without requiring new customer acquisition spend.

Summary Table

# Business Problem	Impact	SQL Query	Recommendation
1 High cancellation rate	₹~1 Cr+ revenue at risk	Q10, Q15	Fix listings, size guides, COD policy
2 Declining monthly revenue	-18.8% in 2 months	Q12, Q17	Investigate marketing & demand drivers
3 No geographic strategy	Resources spread too thin	Q8, Q16	Tiered state investment framework
4 Merchant vs Amazon fulfilment gap	Lower AOV on merchant orders	Q14	Migrate high-value sellers to FBA
5 Wrong category assumptions	Kurta over-invested, Set under-invested	Q9, Q17	Prioritise Set in ad spend & promotions
6 B2B segment invisible	Untapped bulk revenue opportunity	Q6	Launch dedicated B2B programme

This framing shows recruiters that you don't just run SQL queries — you connect data findings to real business consequences and actionable decisions. That's what separates a data analyst from a data entry person.